small valley with steep forested hills rising on either side. A fine mist clung to the conifers, black boulders breaking the orderly line as they rose out of the ground. She could hear water swirling, and guessed that the river the train had followed all the way from Dresden wasn't far off.

She had never seen a town built at the base of a valley. There was no opening through which the eyes could roam, just razor-edged hills blocking one's vision as if someone had come along and cut a knife down the middle of the mountain, trapping the town in the middle.

Their German escort emerged from the station, signaling for the sisters to follow. They walked on a street and entered a building across from the station where a crowd of men and women sat on benches, waiting. The guard instructed them to join these people while he deposited their papers at a desk manned by both uniformed officers and civilians. Then, he left.

Mostly they heard German, though some of the women sitting around them whispered in what Léa guessed might be Italian or Dutch, plus a swirling mix of unfamiliar languages, carrying both light, melodic and hard, guttural ones. The sisters didn't speak. They were so overwhelmed by the hundred or so people waiting with them, some asleep on the benches, others nervously looking around.

"*Schwestern* Cotillard," a stout woman called out from behind the desk.

The sisters stood, Rose clutching the suitcase, and approached the desk.

"I'm Lagerführer Klein, the overseer for your residence camp in Glashütte," she said in a hard, clipped French accent from Alsace. Like Metz, it had been annexed to Germany. "Your resident registration cards must be completed first." She raised her right hand, like a schoolteacher, extending thumb, first and second fingers, enumerating what this entailed. "Fingerprints. Photographs. Medical exams."

She led the sisters into a large room, divided into separate areas by three tables in front of which lines of women waited. At least it was warm inside.

"Join this line," she ordered.

As the sisters stood behind two other women, Léa glanced around and, with a gasp, elbowed Rose.

"What?" Rose whispered.

"Look at the table at the far end."

Rose turned. She raised her hand to cover her mouth. "Oh, please no."

Lagerführer Klein overheard her. "Body examinations are only for the